



AL MAAREF AMERICAN SCHOOL

School Bus Transportation Policy Manual

ACADEMIC YEAR

2026 – 2027

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to establish clear guidelines governing the provision of school transportation services to ensure the safety, security, welfare, and efficient transportation of students while protecting the interests of Al Maaref American School (MAS), Emirates Transport (ET), and all stakeholders.

This policy applies to all student, parents/guardians, transportation staff, school employees, and contracted transportation providers.

2. Policy Statement

Al Maaref American School provides transportation services through Emirates Transport (ET) in accordance with the requirements of:

- Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA)
- Roads and Transport Authority (RTA)
- Emirates Transport Operational Standards
- UAE Traffic Laws
- UAE Child Safety Regulations

Transportation services are considered an optional service and are subject to operational availability, route feasibility, seat availability, and compliance with this policy.

3. Definitions

School: Al Maaref American School (MAS).

Transport Provider: Emirates Transport (ET).

Learner / Student: Any learner / student registered at the school and approved for transportation services.

Parent/Guardian: The person legally responsible for the student.

Bus Supervisor: School or ET representative responsible for transportation coordination.

Force Majeure: Any event beyond the reasonable control of the school including government directives, pandemics, epidemics, natural disasters, severe weather, civil unrest, road closures, security incidents, utility failures, or emergencies.

4. Transportation Registration

4.1 Transportation services are available only upon completion and approval of the official Bus Transportation Application Form (*See Appendix A*).

4.2 Submission of an application does not guarantee transportation services.

4.3 Transportation seats shall be allocated on a first-come, first-served basis.

4.4 Transportation services are provided subject to route availability and operational feasibility.

4.5 The school reserves the right to refuse transportation services where:

- No seats are available.
- The requested location is outside approved routes.
- Access is unsafe for buses.
- Outstanding fees exist.

4.6 Transportation services are offered only as two-way transportation (home-to-school and school-to-home).

One-way transportation services are not available.

5. Transportation Fees

5.1 Transportation fees shall be charged according to the school's approved fee structure.

5.2 Transportation fees are annual fees and are based on reserving a seat for the students for the entire academic year.

5.3 Transportation fees are not calculated on a per-day attendance basis.

5.4 A learner's absence from school, illness, travel, suspension, examination leave, vacation, or other personal circumstances shall not entitle the parent to any transportation fee reduction or refund.

5.5 Transportation services may be suspended if transportation fees remain unpaid.

5.6 The school reserves the right to deny transportation services until all outstanding fees are settled.

6. Transportation Deposit

6.1 A transportation deposit may be required during registration.

6.2 The deposit shall be adjusted against transportation fees.

6.3 Deposits become non-refundable after the deadline specified by the school.

7. Refund Policy

7.1 Transportation fees are non-refundable after the commencement of the academic year except where required by applicable KHDA regulations.

7.2 Approved refunds shall be calculated according to applicable KHDA refund regulations.

7.3 No refund shall be granted due to:

- Student absenteeism.
- Family travel.
- Medical appointments.
- Temporary suspension.
- Examination schedules.
- Route modifications.
- Traffic delays.

7.4 No refund shall be granted for any interruption of transportation services resulting from:

- Government directives.
- Distance learning.
- Online learning.
- Public health emergencies.
- Pandemics.
- Epidemics.
- Natural disasters.
- Severe weather conditions.
- Security incidents.
- Force majeure events.

7.5 Transportation seats remain reserved throughout such periods and related operational costs continue to be incurred.

8. Routes and Pick-up Points

8.1 Transportation routes shall be determined exclusively by the school and Emirates Transport.

8.2 Routes may be modified during the academic year due to operational requirements.

8.3 Pick-up and drop-off points shall be designated by the school.

8.4 The school is not obligated to provide door-to-door transportation.

8.5 Learners may be assigned the nearest safe bus stop.

8.6 Estimated travel times may vary due to traffic and route adjustments.

Routes	Dubai	Sharjah
Short Route	Al Qusais 1, 2 & 3, Al Qusais Indl' 5, Al Nahda 1 & 2, Al Tawar 1, 2 & 3, Al Mamzar, Muhaisna 1, 3 & 4, Abuhail, Hor Al Anz East, Hamriya, Mantaqa Hamdan, Wahudia (Deira), Al Murar, Al Baraha, Hayat Regency Area, Al Muteena, Muraqabat, Al Riga, Baniyas, Mizhar 1, 2 & 3, Oud Al Mateena 1, 2 & 3, Rashdia, Al Garhood, Festival city, Nad Al Hamar, Mirdif Gharoub Appartment & Villas, Mirdif Sharooq, Mirdif Sharooq, Al Warqa 1, 2, 3 & 4, Al Khawaneej 1, 2, 3	Al Nahda 1 & 2 Shj, Al Mamzar Shj, Al Tawun
Long Routes	Mankhool, Port Rashid, Al Diafa, Al Raffa, Umm Hurrair, Satwa, Al Karama, Oud Meetha, Al Jafilliya, Hudaiba, Burjuman	Al Qasba, Al Khan, Abu Shagara, Buhaira Cornish, Al Majaz 1, 2 & 3, Al Majaz 1, 2 & 3, Al Qasmia
New Dubai	Silicon Oasis, Dubai Land, Sports City, IMPZ, Town Square (Meera, Sustainable city, Mudon), Al Barsha 1 & 2, Al Barsha Heights / Tecom, JVC, Damac Hills 2, Arjan, Arbellal, Business Bay, Al Jadaf, Intl' City Phase 1 & 2, Ras Al Khor, Al Quoz 1 & 2, Al Khail Gate, JVC	-

9. Change of Address

9.1 Parents must notify the school immediately regarding any change of residence.

9.2 A written request shall be submitted at least ten (10) working days before implementation.

9.3 Transportation to the new location is subject to route availability.

9.4 If transportation cannot be provided to the new location, transportation fees shall remain subject to KHDA refund regulations.

10. Student Responsibilities

Student must:

- Arrive at the bus stop at least five minutes before pickup time.
- Follow instructions from drivers and bus assistants.
- Remain seated at all times.
- Wear seat belts throughout the journey.
- Respect fellow learners.
- Respect transportation staff.
- Keep buses clean.

- Use appropriate language.
- Maintain proper conduct.

Student shall not:

- Fight.
- Bully.
- Use abusive language.
- Damage bus property.
- Throw objects.
- Open emergency exits.
- Distract drivers.
- Eat or drink on the bus.

11. Parent Responsibilities

Parents shall:

- Ensure student arrive on time.
- Ensure students comply with bus rules.
- Keep contact details updated.
- Inform the school regarding absences affecting transportation.
- Cooperate with transportation staff.

Parents are financially responsible for any damages caused by their child.

12. Pick-up and Drop-off Procedures

12.1 The bus shall not wait for late students.

12.2 If a student misses the bus, transportation to school becomes the parent's responsibility.

12.3 Parents must arrive at the bus stop five minutes before drop-off time.

12.4 KG to Grade 4 students must be received by:

- Parent.
- Guardian.
- Authorized adult.
- Authorized sibling Grade 5 or above.

12.5 If no authorized person is present, the students may be returned to school.

12.6 Any resulting transportation costs may be charged to the parent.

13. Independent Drop-off Authorization

Parents requesting independent drop-off must submit written authorization (*See Appendix B*).

The school shall not be liable for the safety or welfare of learners after disembarkation at the approved location.

This authorization shall not apply to KG–Grade 4 learners.

14. Disciplinary Procedures

Transportation violations may result in:

Level 1 – Verbal Warning

Level 2 – Written Warning

Level 3 – Parent Meeting

Level 4 – Temporary Suspension of Transportation Services

Level 5 – Permanent Withdrawal of Transportation Privileges

The school reserves the right to bypass progressive discipline where safety is compromised.

15. Damage to School Property

Parents shall bear full financial responsibility for:

- Vandalism.
- Damage to seats.
- Damage to safety equipment.
- Damage to bus fixtures.

Repair costs shall be invoiced directly to parents.

16. Medical Emergencies

Transportation staff shall follow Emirates Transport and school emergency procedures.

Emergency medical assistance may be sought when deemed necessary.

Parents authorize emergency treatment where immediate action is required.

All associated costs remain the responsibility of the parent.

17. CCTV, GPS and Data Privacy

All buses are equipped with:

- CCTV cameras.
- GPS tracking.
- Attendance systems.

Parents consent to the collection and use of transportation-related data for safety, security, operational, and regulatory purposes.

18. Limitation Of Liability

The school shall not be liable for:

- Traffic delays.
- Vehicle breakdowns.
- Weather disruptions.
- Route changes.
- Missed activities.
- Indirect losses.
- Consequential damages.

School liability shall be limited to the extent permitted under UAE law.

19. Force Majeure

The school shall not be liable for failure or delay in providing transportation services due to force majeure events.

Transportation fees shall remain payable and non-refundable during such periods unless otherwise required by law.

20. Complaints and Communication

Transportation inquiries shall be directed to:

Transport Supervisor

Email: transport@mas-edu.ae

Operations Department

Email: syed.moosavi@mas-edu.ae

All complaints must be submitted in writing.

21. Policy Amendments

The school reserves the right to amend this policy at any time to comply with regulatory requirements or operational needs.

Updated policies shall supersede previous versions.

Appendix – A



BUS TRANSPORTATION APPLICATION FORM 2026-2027

Complete this application and submit it to the Bus Supervisor.
Submitting this application does not guarantee you bus transportation.

Please note that our bus services are two-way only, and we do not offer one-way service.

Parent ID:		Parent Name:	
Home Telephone:			
Father's Mobile Number:			
Mother's Mobile Number:			

Student Name:		Student ID:		Grade/Section:	
Student Name:		Student ID:		Grade/Section:	
Student Name:		Student ID:		Grade/Section:	
Student Name:		Student ID:		Grade/Section:	

HOME ADDRESS

Please attach a sketch plan detailing the exact location if possible.

Flat / House No.		Building Name:	
Street No. Name:		Area:	
Emirates:		Landmark:	

Please select the options that apply.

- ☐ I request that my child leaves the school bus alone when dropped off. I understand that it is my full responsibility to deal with any consequences and that the school does not hold any liability for the safety of my child once my child leaves the school bus. **Please note that KG-Grade 4 students must be picked up by their parents or accompany by older siblings (Grade 5 and above) from the bus stop.**

- ☒ I have read, understood, and agree to the contents of this form and the Bus Transportation Rules and Regulations.

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____ Date: _____

For Office Use Only

Bus Number (AM Trip):	Pick-up Time:
Bus Number (PM Trip):	Drop-off Time:
Bus Assistant Name:	Date of Application Submission:

Appendix – A (Cont.)



BUS TRANSPORTATION RULES & REGULATIONS 2026–2027

Parents who choose to register their children in the school bus services are kindly requested to understand and comply by the rules and regulations stated below. Please read the following information carefully and then sign the Bus Transportation Parental Consent below and submit the form along with Bus Transportation Application Form to the School Bus Supervisor.

Bus Transportation Registration

1. The school operates the buses in compliance with the guidelines advised by the regulatory authorities.
2. Parents who choose to have their child commute by bus should complete and submit the Bus Transportation Application at the time of registering their child at the school.
3. Availabilities of bus seats are limited; bus transportation applications are processed on a first-come first-serve basis.
4. Only two-way bus services are provided home to school and school to home.
5. Please note that the bus services will not be provided to your residential point, but to the nearest bus stop locations if there is no proper access for the school bus.
6. The deadline for enrollment in Bus Transportation Services for MAS existing & new students is June 26th, 2026 along with a **deposit fee of AED 300**.
7. The deposited fee will be adjusted against the total transportation fee as per the school's fee structure.
8. The deposit fee will not be refunded after 15th August 2026.

Bus Transportation Fees

1. The bus seat will be confirmed, once the application form is accepted and the parent will make full payment of fees based on the fee structure applicable in the school. Failure to pay by the due date may result in suspension of bus services.
2. Bus service enrollment is for the whole academic year, and parents who choose to have their child commute by bus will be charged bus fees for a full academic year.
3. The bus arrangement and seat reservation are made for the full academic year. No refund shall be provided for service interruptions caused by government directives, public emergencies, pandemics, adverse weather, security incidents, or other events beyond the school's control.
4. Bus transportation fees are charged for two-way transportation.
5. Following options are given to the parents for payment of fee:
 - a. Cash / Credit Cards at the Accounts counter in the school.
 - b. Cheque in favor of 'School Name' at the Accounts counter in the school.

Cancellation

1. Cancellation requests should be submitted in writing or by email (transport@mas-edu.ae) at least 30 days in advance.
2. Once the bus service has commenced for the academic year, transportation fees are non-refundable except where a refund is required by applicable KHDA regulations or at the sole discretion of the school.
3. The school may decline a bus transportation application in case the student moves to an area that lies outside the school bus trip routes.

Change in Residential Address

1. In case of a change in the student's residence, please inform the Bus Supervisor in writing or by email;
2. (transport@mas-edu.ae).
3. In case of a change in a student's residence after the commencement of the school year, parents must complete the Bus Location Change Application Form and submit it to the Bus Supervisor **10 days before** the request is processed.
4. In case of a change in a student's residence after the commencement of the school year, and the school is not able to provide transportation to that area or if the parent does not agree to the pickup or drop off timings or location, bus fees will be charged as per KHDA policy.

Rules for Pick Up and Drop Off

1. The travel time may vary depending on the number of students / change in routes.
2. The school is not liable for delays caused by traffic, weather, road closures, vehicle breakdowns, or other circumstances beyond its reasonable control.

Appendix – A (Cont.)



3. Students must wait at the bus stop 5 minutes before the scheduled time of pick-up. If the bus arrives at the stop at the scheduled time and the student is not there, the bus will not wait and will continue its trip.
4. Students are not allowed to leave the bus or leave unattended items on the bus once they board the bus.
5. Parents/guardians should wait for their children at the bus stop where they are dropped off 5 minutes prior to the scheduled time of the bus arrival. If the parent/guardian is not at the bus stop when the bus arrives, then the student remains on the bus and will be returned to school.
6. Parents/guardians who request that their children leave the school bus alone when dropped off should understand that once their children leave the bus at the agreed location, their safety is fully the parents'/guardians' responsibility, and the school does not hold any liability. "Note that KG-Grade 4 students must be picked up by their parents or accompany by older siblings (Grade 5 and above) from the bus stop."
7. In certain cases, parents' advice the bus staff from their balconies/residence to drop the students; in such cases the parents must give a letter undertaking that it is acceptable to them to drop of the students if they are visible to the bus staff. If such an undertaking is not given and an adult is not available to receive the child/children, they will be brought back to the school. If the younger students have older siblings (Year 5 & above) travelling with them, and an undertaking has been given that they can be dropped in the care of the older sibling, this will be facilitated.

Student Conduct

Students must abide by all school rules and school bus rules and regulations. **Students who repeatedly break the school bus rules or behave in a manner that threatens the safety of others on the bus will result in issuing a warning letter and denied the privilege to use the school bus services (if required) after evaluation. If a student damages school bus equipment or fixtures, financial liabilities for any damages will be incurred and will be paid by the parent.**

To ensure the safety of all students on the bus, students should abide by the following rules:

- Arrive on time for the bus; and board and disembark the bus in a safe and proper manner.
- Always remain seated with the seat belt on until dismissed.
- Sit quietly and refrain from disturbing others.
- Be polite and respectful with other students, the bus driver and bus assistant.
- Refrain from pushing or fighting with others.
- Refrain from any behavior that might endanger the safety of others.
- Refrain tampering with or damaging bus equipment, including scribbling on bus walls or seats.
- Refrain from eating or drinking on the bus.
- Refrain from littering in the school and throwing objects in and out of the bus.
- Respect and follow the instructions of the driver and bus assistant.

Deadline Dates & Communication

1. Deadlines:
 - Enrollment in Bus Transportation Services for MAS existing and new students: 26th June 2026.
 - Change in residential address: 20th August 2026.
2. Please communicate cancellations or any changes to your residential address or bus stop locations to the Bus Supervisor in writing or by email. (transport@mas-edu.ae)
3. For any suggestions or complaints, please email to Manager Operations (syed.moosavi@mas-edu.ae).

☒ I have read, understood, and agree to abide by all the above mentioned.

Parent Name: _____

Parent Signature: _____

Date: _____

Appendix – B



INDEPENDENT DROP-OFF AUTHORIZATION

Student Name	
Grade/Section	
Bus No.	
Transport Services	
Parent Name	
Mobile No.	
Drop off Location	

I **(Parent Name)** hereby grant permission to drop off my son/daughter at the reception area located within the specified building as stated in this form.

I understand that I will be responsible for my child upon drop-off at the reception, and I assume full responsibility for any circumstances that may arise during this time.

Parent Signature/Date.....

Approved By.....

Signature/Date.....